Devotions

One passage per sheet. Stay in what it says before you ask what it means to you.

Date: _____
Passage: _____
Translation: _____

BOOK | WHERE I AM IN IT | HOW LONG I SAT WITH IT | READ IT ALOUD? ☐

1 BEFORE I READ

Not to arrive calm — to notice what I brought, so I can tell it apart from what I find

What I am carrying in — distracted, angry, numb, rushed, hopeful, nothing much:

A prayer before reading, one line:

2 WHAT IT ACTUALLY SAYS

Stay here longer than feels necessary. Everything below is only as good as this part.

☐ narrative ☐ law ☐ psalm / poetry ☐ wisdom ☐ prophecy ☐ gospel ☐ parable ☐ epistle ☐ apocalyptic ☐ genealogy / list ☐ song ☐ prayer

OR — WHAT KIND OF WRITING IS THIS?

The genre decides which questions apply. A psalm is not asking to be obeyed the way a command is. A narrative is not always endorsing what it reports. Wisdom describes how things generally go, not what God has promised you personally. Read accordingly.

Retell the passage in my own words, in three sentences. No interpretation yet — just what happens, or what is claimed.

What repeats? What contrasts? Where does it turn — the *but*, *therefore*, *so that*, *because*?

What surprised me, or is not how I would have written it?

What I do not understand. Leave it as a question — do not resolve it just to fill the line.

3 THE RING AROUND IT

A verse lifted out of its paragraph will say almost anything you want

What happens immediately before and after?

Who wrote it, to whom, and what were they actually dealing with?

☐ creation ☐ the fall ☐ Abraham ☐ exodus ☐ law & covenant ☐ wilderness ☐ the land ☐ kings ☐ prophets ☐ exile ☐ return ☐ the life of Christ ☐ cross & resurrection ☐ the church ☐ new creation

WHERE THIS SITS IN THE WHOLE STORY

4 WHAT IT SHOWS ABOUT GOD

Before it is about me. This is the question that is easiest to skip.

About God — Father, Son, Spirit. What is he like here? What does he do, want, refuse, promise?

About people, including me. What are we like here — and is the passage describing us or commanding us?

Where is Christ in this passage — directly, by promise, by pattern, or by contrast? If the honest answer is "not obviously," write that.

5 THE VERSE I AM TAKING WITH ME

REFERENCE: _____

Write it out by hand. Copying is slower than reading, and that is the entire point.

6 WHAT IT ASKS OF ME

Not application in the abstract — a person, a place, and a week

WHAT THIS ASKS OF ME	WHERE EXACTLY — WHO, WHEN, THIS WEEK	BY WHEN	✓

What is the honest resistance? What here do I not want to do?

What would change this week if I actually believed this passage?

7 PRAYER

Use the passage's own words where you can — it is better at this than I am

	IN MY OWN WORDS	WORDS FROM THE PASSAGE
Adore		
Confess		
Thank		
Ask		

STILL PRAYING FOR — AND SINCE WHEN

ANSWERED — AND WHEN

8 HONEST, AND UNFINISHED

Dry days are not failed days. A sheet that cannot record one will teach me to fake it.

If nothing landed today, say it plainly — what was it like to sit here anyway?

A QUESTION I AM CARRYING	WHERE I MIGHT LOOK — COMMENTARY, PERSON, CROSS-REFERENCE	ASKED?

One thing from this I want to tell someone this week — and who:

The thread so far — what has this book been doing across the last few sittings?

9 NEXT SITTING

So the stack stays a book and not a pile of good mornings

NEXT PASSAGE

WHEN

ONE THING TO REREAD FIRST